Minutes of the Special Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held at the Carruthers Marsh Pavilion on Tuesday, February 28, 2023 at 12:30 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 12:33 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Opening Remarks / Welcome

Mayor Collier highlighted the important role the Strategic Plan plays in the civic life of the community and noted the achievements resulting from the 2019-2022 Strategic Plan. He further thanked staff in Public and Strategic Affairs for organizing the session and the opportunity before Council to continue delivering on commitments made by individual members of Council for the Ajax community.

4. Council Strategic Planning Session

Natasha Sharma, Diversity and Inclusion Coordinator, provided an overview of the Strategic Planning Session and set expectations for participants. N. Sharma highlighted that the session was intended to serve as a brainstorming session, build upon preparatory work completed by staff in advance of the session and highlighted subsequent opportunities for Council Members to engage in further discussions.

Christie McLardie, Manager of Public and Strategic Affairs, provided a presentation highlighting the process undertaken by staff leading to the Strategic Planning Session and the specific activities undertaken by individual members of the Public and Strategic Affairs (PSA) team and how the resulting plan will be utilized by staff across the organization. C.

McLardie discussed the changes implemented to the process in response to Council Members feedback and input received from the community and staff in advance of the session. C. McLardie identified that the pillars and priorities used to guide the session were drawn from themes which emerged over the course of discussions with individual Members of Council, staff and the public.

Liam Nichols, Grants and Special Initiatives Coordinator, delivered a presentation summarizing preliminary community polling data compiled by Environs on behalf of the Town. Polling focused on municipal issues and included a comparison of data compiled in 2019 and 2023. Council Members posed questions about the polling results and staff responded to questions.

A video montage of Town Directors identifying key operational priorities and challenges was shared with Council Members.

Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, addressed Members of Council and highlighted the significant accomplishments achieved since his tenure with the Town began. S. Baker noted the challenges which faced the Town due to a history of underinvestment in strategic planning guiding the Town's operations. S. Baker spoke of the strong foundation that now exists and the need for the organization to transition and deliver on the strategies now in place. Finally, S. Baker thanked PSA staff for their hard work in bringing the session to fruition and highlighted the ongoing work to modernize systems and processes through the Core Service Review program and activities underway to recruit and retain talent in a competitive labour market.

C. McLardie introduced a brainstorming exercise to ensure that all priorities aligning to the key pillars of the Strategic Plan had been captured. Members of the PSA team and Senior Management Team led Members through the exercise.

N. Sharma introduced participants to the prioritization and confirmation exercise. C. McLardie led Council Members and the Senior Leadership Team through the exercise. Council Members and the Senior Management Team discussed proposed activities and the feasibility of completing such activities within the current term of Council.

5. Closing Remarks

Mayor Collier delivered closing remarks thanking staff and Members of Council for their hard work and commitment to the strategic planning process and communicated next steps for the benefit of Council Members.

S. Baker highlighted the collaborative culture within the Town and the positive working relationship and respect that exists between Council Members and staff. S. Baker thanked Council Members and staff for their contributions.

6. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: R. Tyler-Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 07-2023 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its special meeting held on February 28, 2023 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

7. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the February 28, 2023 Special meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (4:42 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

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D-Clerk